

Lesson 19: Publishing and Sharing in Power BI

1. What is the difference between Power BI Desktop and Power BI Online Service?

Power BI Desktop is a Windows application used to create and design reports and data models. Power BI Online Service (app.powerbi.com) is a cloud platform where you can publish, share, and collaborate on reports and dashboards. Desktop is for building; Service is for sharing.

2. How do you publish a Power BI report from Desktop to the Online Service?

In Power BI Desktop, click File → Publish → To Power BI, then sign in to your Power BI account and choose a workspace. The report and its dataset will be uploaded to the online service.

3. What is a workspace in Power BI? What are the types of workspaces available?

A workspace is a container in Power BI Service that holds datasets, reports, and dashboards. There are two types: My Workspace (personal) and Shared/Workspace (collaborative).

4. What is the difference between a workspace and an app in Power BI?

A workspace is where reports and dashboards are created collaboratively, while an app is a packaged, read-only version shared with users.

5. Explain the different Power BI license types and their limitations.

Free – limited to My Workspace only. Pro – enables sharing and collaboration. Premium – provides larger storage, faster performance, and allows free users to view shared content.

6. How can you share a report with someone who doesn't have a Pro license?

You can share reports with free users only if they are hosted in a Premium capacity workspace.

7. What is a semantic model (dataset) in Power BI, and where is it stored in the service?

A semantic model (dataset) is the data model containing imported or connected data. It is stored in the workspace where the report is published.

8. How does Scheduled Refresh work in Power BI Online Service?

Scheduled Refresh automatically updates datasets in Power BI Service at defined intervals to keep reports current.

9. What is the difference between a dataset and a dataflow in Power BI?

A dataset is a ready-to-use model for reporting, while a dataflow is a reusable ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) process stored in the service.

10. When and why would you use a dataflow instead of a dataset?

Use dataflows when multiple datasets or reports need the same transformed data. It centralizes and reuses data preparation logic.

11. What are dashboards in Power BI Online? How are they different from reports?

A dashboard is a single-page view with visuals pinned from multiple reports. Reports are multi-page and detailed.

12. How do you pin a visual to a dashboard from a report?

Open the report → hover over the visual → click the pin icon → choose a dashboard to pin it to.

13. What is the mobile view in Power BI and why is it useful?

Mobile view optimizes report layout for phones and tablets, improving readability and navigation on mobile devices.

14. What is a paginated report in Power BI and when would you use it?

A paginated report is a formatted, print-ready report used for invoices, statements, or documents that require fixed page layouts.

15. Can you export reports from Power BI Service to PDF or PowerPoint? How?

Yes. Open the report → File → Export → PDF or PowerPoint to generate and download the export.

16. What does “Live Connection” mean in Power BI Service, and how does it work?

A Live Connection keeps the report connected directly to the data source or dataset without importing data, allowing real-time updates.

17. Explain Row-Level Security (RLS) and how it's applied in Power BI Online.

RLS restricts data access for specific users based on defined roles. Roles are created in Desktop and enforced in the Service.

18. How can you test RLS roles in Power BI Service?

Go to the dataset → click Security → choose a role → Test as role to view data as specific users.

19. What are Apps in Power BI and how do you publish one?

An App is a packaged collection of reports and dashboards. To publish: go to workspace → Publish app → configure → Publish.

20. What are some key benefits of using the Power BI Online Service in enterprise environments?

Collaboration and sharing, centralized data, automatic refresh, strong security, integration with Microsoft 365, and scalability.